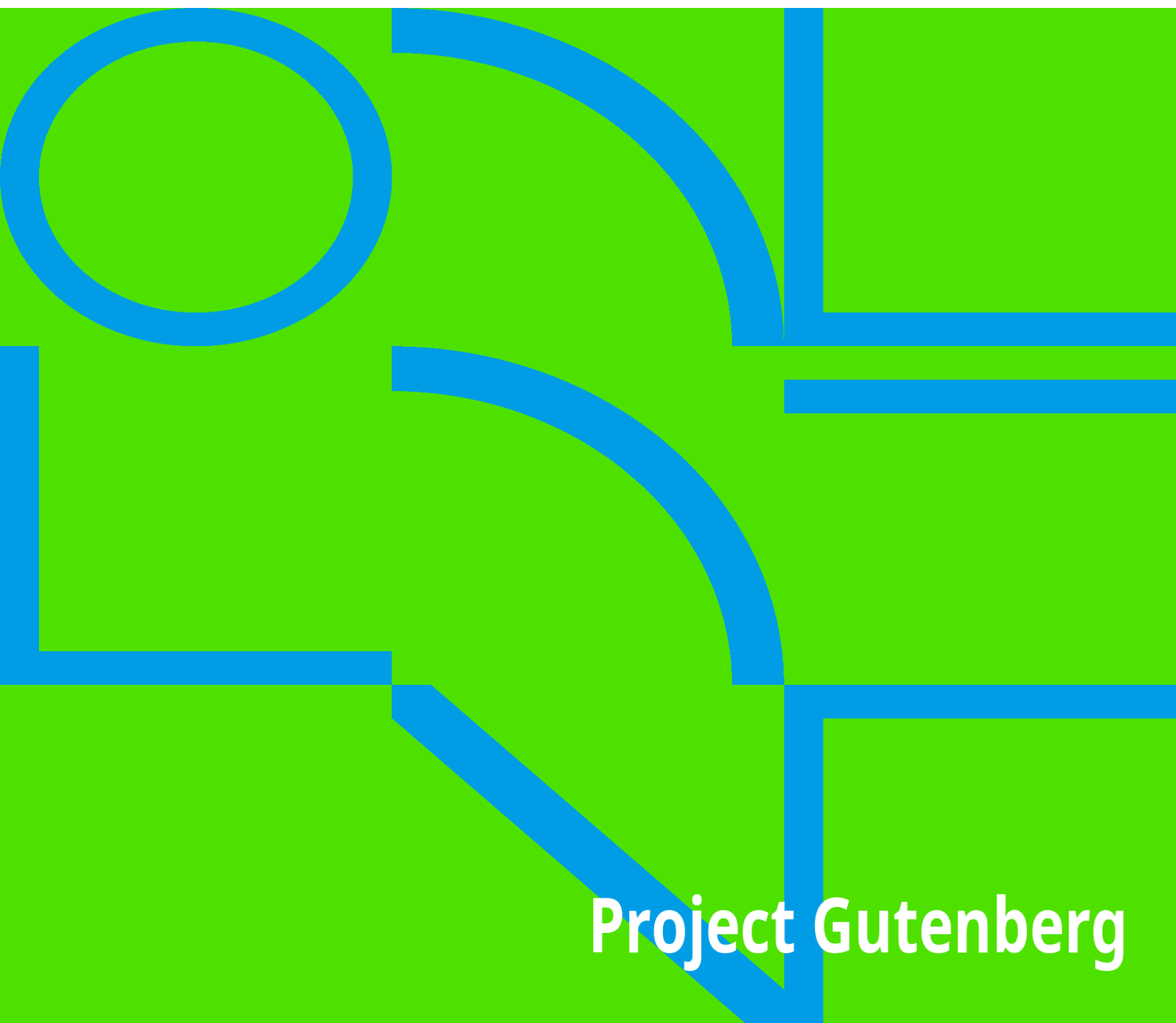


Willie Mouse

Alta Tabor



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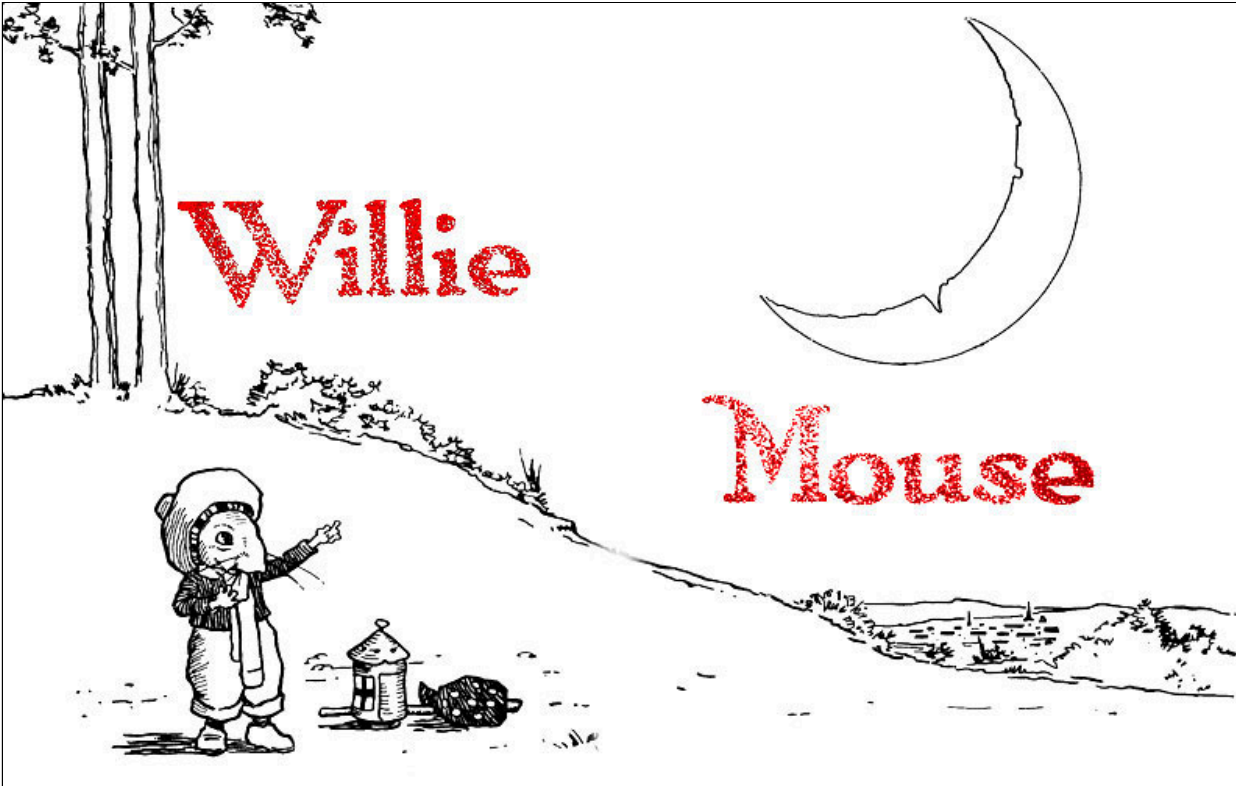
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Willie Mouse

by

Alta Tabor



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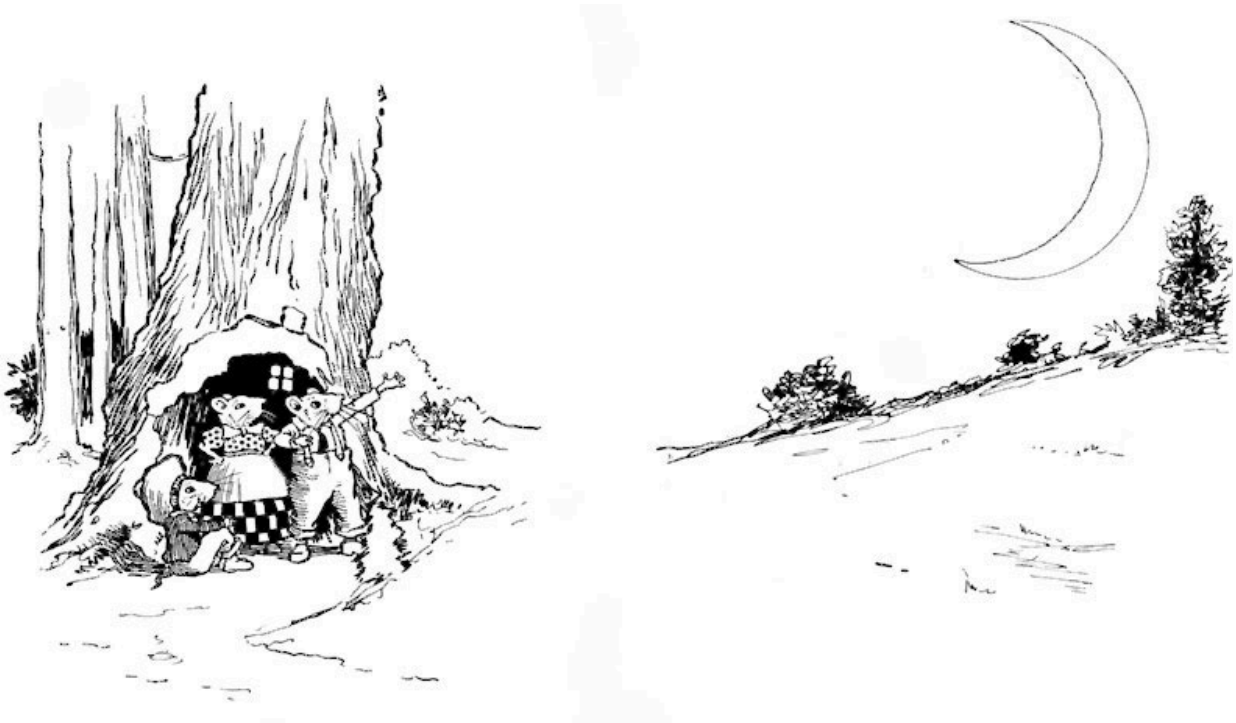
Willie Mouse
Goes on a Journey to
Find the Moon



Willie Mouse

Willie Mouse had often heard his Ma and Pa say that the moon was made of green cheese, and one evening he thought he would see if he could find it.

He packed up a piece of cheese and a crust of bread, and, taking his lantern, set out on his travels.





He had not gone far when he met his friend, Mr. Woodmouse, who asked him where he was going.

“Oh!” said Willie, “I'm going to find the moon; it's made of green cheese, you know.”

“I don't believe it's made of green cheese at all,” said Mr. Woodmouse, but Willie wouldn't listen to him and went on his way.



Coming round by Clover Green whom should he meet but Miss Jenny Wren, looking very gay in her yellow bonnet.

“Where are you off to?” she asked.

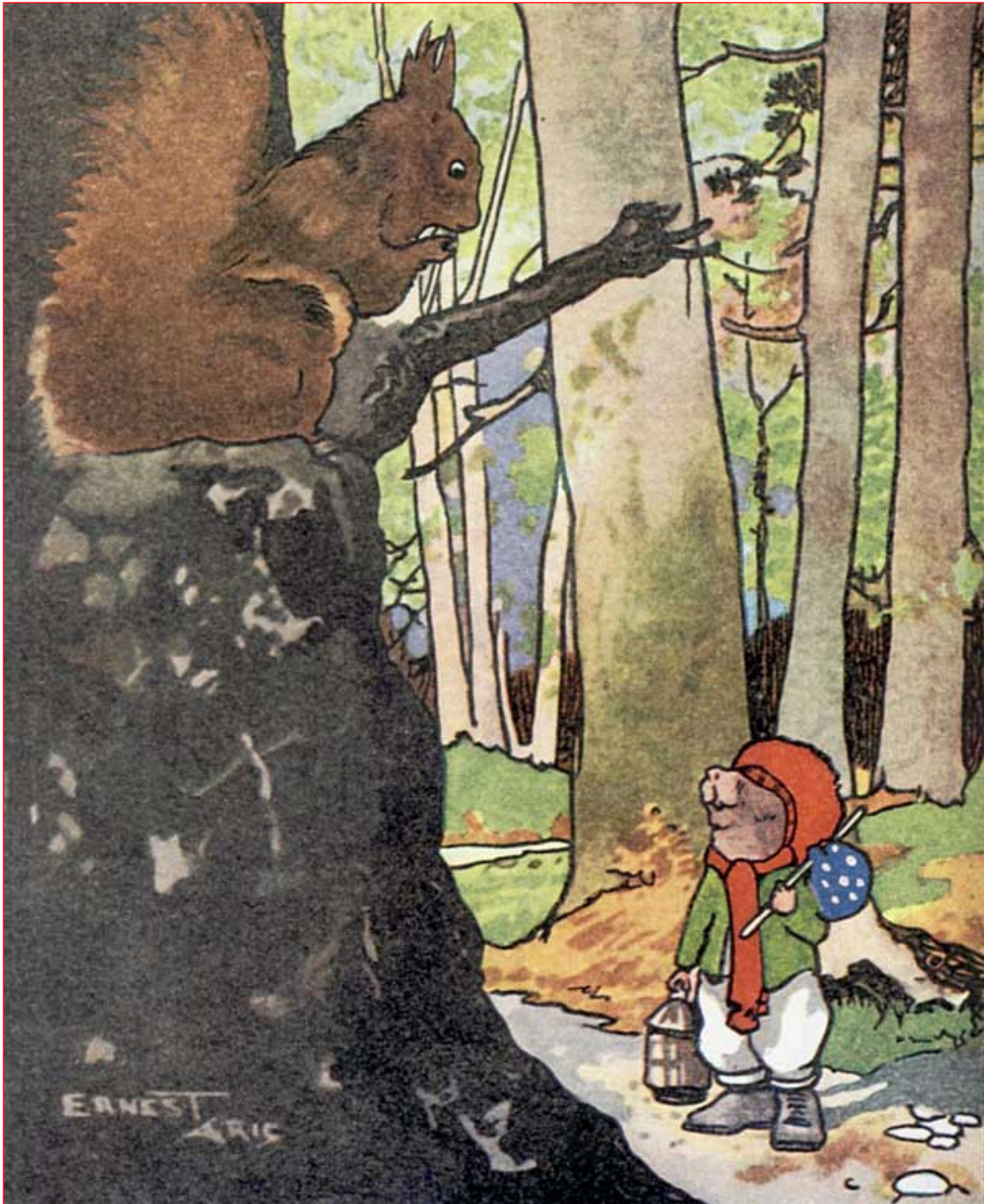
“I'm on my way to find the moon.”

“The moon!” cried Miss Wren, “you'll never reach it.”



“I flew ever so high one evening and I didn't seem to get any nearer.”

“Well,” said Willie, “why should it be made of green cheese if you can't reach it?” And on he went.



Presently he came up to a wood, and looking up he saw Mr. Squirrel jumping from branch to branch.

“Good afternoon,” he said.

“You do seem high up. Surely you can tell me the way to the moon. It's made of green cheese, you know.”



“I don't think it's made of green cheese; why shouldn't it be made of nuts?”

“How ignorant everybody is,” said Willie Mouse to himself.





So on he went once more until he came to a little hole in the ground, and being very curious he peeped

inside. There sat Mrs. Mole, who came out when she saw him.

“Do you live down there?” asked Willie politely.



“Yes,” replied Mrs. Mole.

“Then I'm afraid you can't tell me how to get to the moon. It's made of green cheese, you know; Ma says so.”

“Nonsense, my child. Don't waste your time looking for the moon; keep your eyes open for worms.”



Willie said “Good-bye” to Mrs. Mole. Then he sat down and opened his parcel because it was getting late and he thought he had better have some dinner.

“I may not reach the moon yet awhile,” he thought, “so I had better save a little piece of cheese for supper.”







After dinner he fell asleep, and on waking he found that it was quite dark. He looked up and there was the

moon right high up in the sky.

“Oh, Mr. Moon!” he cried, “You do seem a long way away. I think it would be much easier for you to come down here than for me to get up there.” But Mr. Moon stayed where he was.







Looking up Willie Mouse saw two big eyes gleaming in the dark. They belonged to Mrs. Owl, and as Willie

was only a little mouse he didn't know that Mrs. Owl had a special liking for little mice.



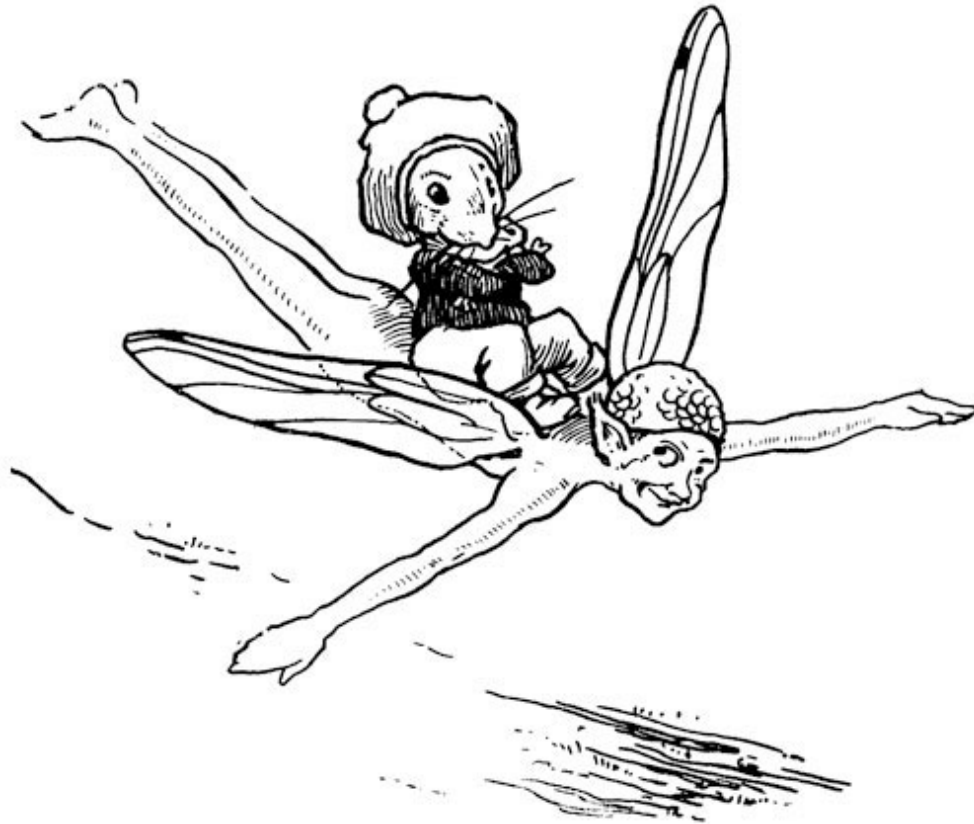
“Please, Mrs. Owl,” said he, “how can I get to the moon?”

Down flew Mrs. Owl. “This is the way to the moon,” she said, and she caught him up in her beak and carried him back to the owl house where she lived.



When Willie Mouse saw all the owlets with their beaks gaping open he began to be frightened, for he feared that Mrs. Owl was going to eat him all up. But

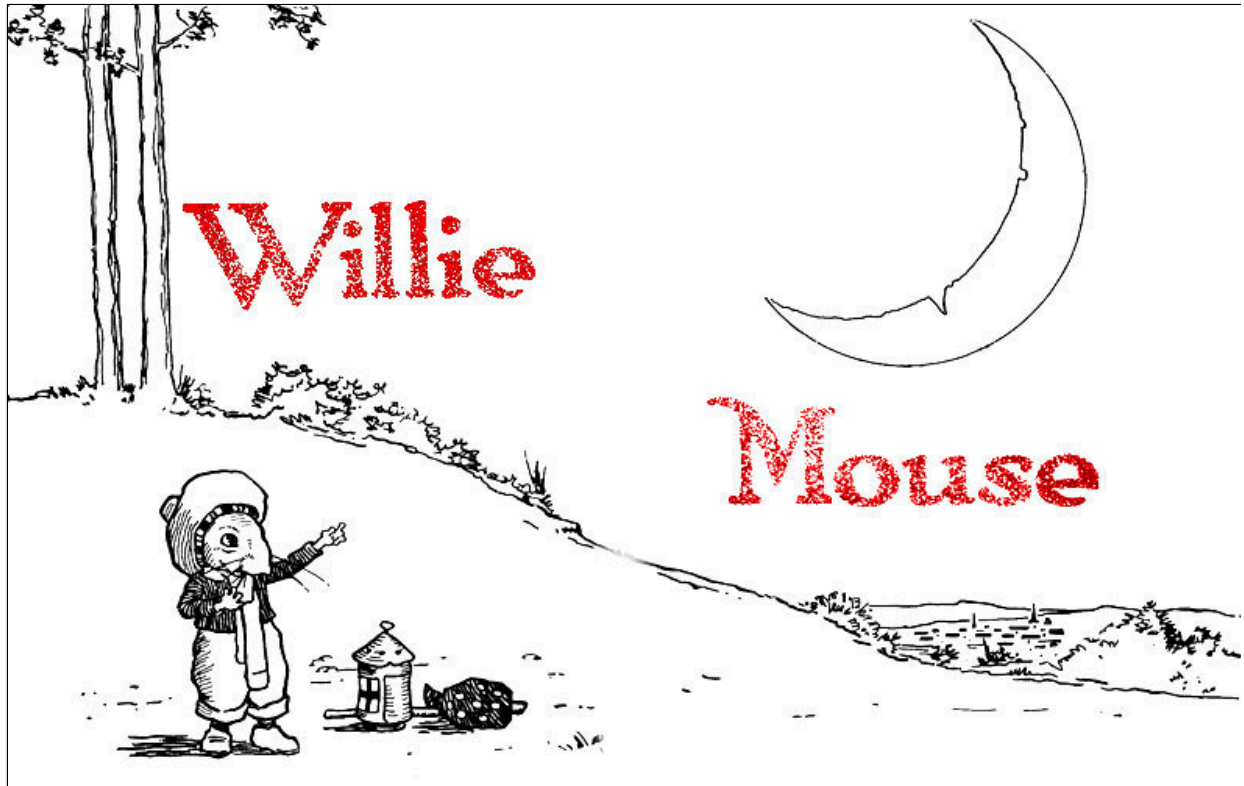
he didn't know that a good green elf, who lived in the trunk of the tree, was near at hand, and just as Mrs. Owl opened her beak the leaves rustled and there stood Mr. Elf, who jumped to the ground with Willie on his back.



When the good green elf had shown him the way home he thought he would ask him if the moon were really made of green cheese, but all of a sudden Mr. Elf disappeared, and Willie Mouse still thinks that one day he will find the moon and have enough cheese to last him all his life.



But he will wait until he is a little older and bigger before he tries to jump to the moon. And perhaps by that time he may be wiser, too.



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Little Black Sambo

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